



Seasoned warrior: Lovlina Borgohain, the Birmingham 2022 champion in the 70kg category and Tokyo Olympic bronze medallist, combines physical strength, reach and experience. RITU RAJ KONWAR

pathway for Glasgow 2026, brought several future contenders into focus. Malaysia's Muhammad Aznil Bidin (65kg), Canada's Braydon Kennedy (88kg), Malaysia's Mohamad Nor-Azmi Ghazali (94kg), reigning champion Chris Murray (England, 81kg), and Fiji's Taniela Rainibogi (110kg) are among the lifters who could stand between India and the medals.

The women's competition, in particular, will feature some of the biggest names in Commonwealth weightlifting. Canada's Maude Charron, an Olympic champion in Tokyo and a two-time Commonwealth Games gold medallist (2018 and 2022), will be the star attraction in the 63kg category.

Australia's Eileen Cikamatana, the defending Commonwealth champion in the 86kg division, remains a formidable rival. England's Emily Campbell, the Birmingham 2022 champion and an Olympic medallist at Tokyo 2020 and Paris 2024, will be aiming to defend her super-heavyweight crown (+87kg).

India, however, will not arrive as a mere challenger. It will field some of the biggest names in Commonwealth sport.

Leading the charge will be Lovlina Borgohain in women's boxing (75kg) and two-time Commonwealth Games gold medallist Mirabai Chanu in weightlifting (48kg).

Lovlina, the Birmingham 2022 Commonwealth champion in the 70kg category and Tokyo Olympic bronze medallist, combines physical strength, reach and experience acquired on the biggest stages.

However, she will need to rediscover her best form after a fluctuating period since her Olympic breakthrough. Australia's Emma-Sue

Greentree is expected to be among her principal rivals.

In women's featherweight boxing (57kg), reigning world champion Jaismine Lamboria will carry India's biggest hopes for gold. The 24-year-old from Bhiwani has reinvented herself since dropping from 60kg to 57kg in 2024, gaining speed, sharper movement, and greater control and effectiveness.

She will be eager to improve on the bronze medal she won in Birmingham.

Tall, quick and technically gifted, Jaismine uses her reach intelligently, controls distance with an effective jab and has developed into a boxer capable of both outscoring opponents from range and stepping up the pressure when required.

She is among India's most exciting prospects to watch in Glasgow.

Sachin Siwach (**right**) is another emerging star from the famed Bhiwani boxing belt.

After making his mark at the youth level with medals at the World